FANTASY CRUX LITE

The whole game in a few pages, for fast play and convention tables.



WHAT IS LITE?

Fantasy Crux is a gritty percentile game about capable adventurers. Violence is dangerous, preparation matters, and Hero Points leave room for epic reversals.

Lite is the same game with its side rules folded together. Almost everything is a skill test, and almost every special case is a reason to add **Bonus or Penalty dice**. An experienced Gamemaster can read it in an evening and run it from memory.

USING LITE

Lite keeps the **same numbers** as the full rules: characteristics, skills, weapons, armour, wounds and Shaping. Characters, creatures and adventures for Fantasy Crux 2.0 work in Lite unchanged, and so do any Talents a character has.

When Lite is silent, use the full rules at fantasycrux.org, or make a quick ruling and keep playing.

YOU NEED

Two ten-sided dice for percentile rolls, one for tens and one for units, plus a few spare ten-sided dice for Bonus and Penalty dice. A D4, D6, D8, D10 and D12 for damage. A character sheet and a pencil for each player.

CONTENTS

- **Play** and **Circumstances**: tests and the dice that modify them.
- **Characters** and **Improvement and Talents**: build and improve a character.
- **Combat** and **More Combat**: fights, wounds and healing.
- **Equipment** and **Adventuring**: gear, travel and hazards.
- **Shaping**: magic, in two pages.
- **Gamemaster**: running tests, quick NPCs and common creatures.

PLAY

Say what you try. Roll only when failure would matter.

MAKE A TEST

1. Say what your character wants and how they try.
2. The GM names the **skill** and any **Bonus or Penalty dice**. Routine and impossible tasks need no roll.
3. Roll **D100**: a tens die and a units die read 01 to 100; 00 is 100. A result at or under the skill succeeds.
4. Apply the result and play on. Do not repeat the test until something changes.

RESULT GRADES

Roll	Grade
01 to the skill's tens digit	**Critical:** success with an extra benefit.
At or under the skill	**Success.**
Over the skill	**Failure.**
99–00; only 00 at 100%	**Fumble:** failure with a consequence fitting the risk.

A 59% skill is Critical on 01–05; any skill above 0% is Critical on 01. A Fumble overrides success. Skills never exceed 100%.

A **Critical** succeeds especially quickly, thoroughly or well, and can reveal something extra. A **Fumble** adds a serious consequence that follows from the risk: lost time, broken gear, danger or a worse position.

BONUS AND PENALTY DICE

Each **+1B** adds one tens die and you keep the best result; each **-1P** adds one and you keep the worst. Pair every tens die with the same units die. Cancel them one for one and keep at most **+3B or -3P**.

Best result: the higher grade first (Critical, Success, Failure, Fumble). Among successes the higher roll is better; among failures, the lower.

> **Example.** Skill 70%, +1B: units 5, tens 2 and 6 give 25 or 65. Both succeed, so keep 65.

OPPOSED TESTS

When someone resists, both roll. The higher grade wins. With the same grade, the higher success wins, or the lower failure. Still tied: the higher skill wins, then the defender; with no defender, nothing changes. Two successes of 42 and 31: 42 wins. Two failures of 72 and 85: 72 wins.

LET THE FICTION LEAD

Rules settle uncertain moments; they do not replace common sense. The GM can grant dice for a strong advantage, rule that size or anatomy makes an action impossible, or let an obvious approach succeed without a roll. Say so before the roll.

HELP

Helpers who know the job, with 26% or more in the skill, give **+1B in total**, not per helper. Exceptional teamwork can give +2B.

GROUP TESTS

If one failure sinks everyone, such as sneaking past a guard, roll once for the weakest member. If one success is enough, such as spotting an ambush, roll once for the best, with +1B for the others' help.

HERO POINTS

Each player character starts with **2**; the GM awards more for heroic play. Spend 1 to:

- **Reroll** a failed test, before its consequences. One reroll per test.
- **Downgrade a Major Wound:** keep the HP loss, but not Wounded or Bleeding.
- **Avoid Death:** at 0 HP, become stable and unconscious. Wake after the scene with 1 HP.
- **Story benefit:** with GM approval, add a plausible favourable detail.

EXAMPLE OF PLAY

Corin sneaks past a sentry at night: Deception 55% against the sentry's Perception 45%. Moonlight is partial darkness, so the sentry rolls at -1P, and Corin's dark cloak gives him +1B. Corin's dice read 25 or 65; he keeps 25, a Success. The sentry's read 38 or 78; he must keep 78, a Failure. Corin slips past.

DICE AND TIME

2D6+1 means roll two six-sided dice and add 1. Round to the nearest whole number; halves round up. A **round** is five seconds. A **scene** is one continuous situation, such as a fight, a chase or a negotiation. Distances are in metres; on a grid, a square is 2 m.

CIRCUMSTANCES

Most special rules are reasons to add Bonus or Penalty dice.

ADD DICE FOR WHAT MATTERS

A clear advantage is **+1B**, a clear problem **-1P**; two dice are for strong factors. Add up different causes, but use only the strongest of one kind, such as the worst cover. Then cancel and cap at +3B or -3P. Judge new cases alike.

YOUR CONDITION

You are...	Dice
Wounded, after a Major Wound	-1P on every test
Fatigued / Exhausted	-1P / -2P on every test
Held in a grapple, or holding someone	-1P on every test
Below a weapon's STR or DEX minimum	-1P with that weapon
Overloaded: over STR + SIZ in ENC	-1P on physical tests
On unstable ground	-1P

CLOSE COMBAT

Situation	Dice
Target prone, flanked or attacked from behind	+1B to attack
You have higher ground	+1B to your own rolls
You are prone	-1P to your own rolls
Fighting underwater	-2P
Rider against someone on foot	Rider +1B; foe -1P to defend
Target helpless	Automatic Critical

SKILLS AND TASKS

Situation	Dice
Good tools: climbing kit, crowbar, lock picks	+1B
A sound plan, or real leverage	+1B
A successful related Lore test just before	+1B to one test
Skilled helpers	+1B in total
Healing without a Healing Kit	-2P
Resisting poison or disease after treatment	+1B

RANGED ATTACKS

Situation	Dice
You spent a Combat Action to Aim at the target	+1B
Beyond Range, up to twice Range	-2P
Partial / substantial cover	-1P / -2P
Target moved 10 m / 30 m since your last turn	-1P / -2P
Target partly / heavily hidden by mist, smoke or foliage	-1P / -2P
Target prone	-1P
Target helpless	+2B
You are prone	-2P
An enemy is adjacent to you	-2P per enemy
High wind / fierce wind	-1P / -3P

LIGHT

Light at the target counts for seeing and attacking; light at you, for moving. Radius: candle 1 m, torch or lantern 3 m, campfire 5 m, bonfire 10 m.

Light	Effect
Daylight, or within a light's radius	None
Partial darkness: twilight, or up to 3× a radius	-1P to sight-based Perception and attacks
Darkness: starlight, or up to 5× a radius	-2P to them; half Movement
Pitch black	Sight fails; close attacks -3P; quarter Movement

Low-Light Sight counts partial darkness as light and darkness as partial darkness. **Night Vision** counts natural night outdoors as light.

EXAMPLE

An archer aims at a running orc behind a low wall at dusk. Aim gives +1B; the orc moved 10 m (-1P), has partial cover (-1P) and stands in partial darkness (-1P). Net: **-2P**. Roll three tens dice and keep the worst result.

CHARACTERS

Build a character in six steps, or play a ready-made one.

1. CONCEPT

Write one sentence: who they are, what they do well and what drives them.

2. ANCESTRY AND CHARACTERISTICS

Start from your ancestry's spread and add **30 points**. No score above 18; INT and SIZ at least 7, the rest at least 3. **Quick human:** assign 16, 14, 13, 12, 11, 10 and 10.

Ancestry	STR	CON	DEX	SIZ	INT	POW	CHA
Human	8	8	8	8	8	8	8
Elf	6	8	10	6	10	8	8
Dwarf	10	12	6	4	8	8	8
Orc	10	8	8	10	6	6	8
Goblin	6	7	12	4	9	8	10
Lizardfolk	11	8	6	8	9	7	7

Ancestry abilities cost IP from your starting 10 (step 5). **Human** (0 IP): none. **Elf** (5 IP): Low-Light Sight; in forests, ignore one Penalty die on Natural Lore. **Dwarf** (7 IP): Blind Sight (heat); Earth Sense, knowing your depth and whether a cave is unstable while touching stone. **Orc** (4 IP): Adrenaline Surge: once per fight, on becoming Wounded or Fatigued, ignore both penalties until the end of your next turn. **Goblin** (5 IP): Blind Sight (heat). **Lizardfolk** (6 IP): scaled hide, +1 AP that stacks with armour; a tail that gives -1P to attempts to trip, throw or push you.

Blind Sight (heat) perceives warm bodies without light, but no colour, writing or fine detail; walls and insulation block it.

3. ATTRIBUTES

Attribute	Value
Hit Points (HP)	(SIZ + CON) / 2
Major Wound Level (MWL)	HP / 2
Power Points (PP)	POW
Movement	15 m a round
Combat Order	(DEX + INT) / 2, minus armour ENC
Carrying capacity	STR + SIZ, in ENC

Recalculate them whenever a characteristic changes. **Damage Modifier (DM),** from STR + SIZ: 1–10 **-1D6**; 11–15 **-1D4**; 16–25 **+0**; 26–30 **+1D4**; 31–45 **+1D6**; 46–60 **+2D6**; 61–75 **+3D6**; each 15 more, another +1D6.

4. SKILLS

Every character has every skill at its base. Add **50 points to Resistances, 50 to Combat, 50 to Knowledge and 75 to Practical** skills, at most 30 to any one skill. Each Craft, Culture, Language and Lore subject is a separate skill.

Resistances	Base	Use
Dodge	DEX + 10	Avoid harm
Persistence	POW + 10	Resist fear
Resilience	CON + POW	Endure harm
Combat	**Base**	**Use**
Close Combat	DEX + STR	Weapons, shields
Ranged Combat	DEX + INT	Shoot, throw
Unarmed Combat	DEX + STR	Punch, grapple
Knowledge	**Base**	**Use**
Culture (own)	INT + 10	Customs
Culture (other)	INT	Customs
Language (own)	INT + 50	Speak
Language (other)	INT	50% is fluent
Lore (own field)	INT + 10	Study
Lore (other)	INT	Study
Natural Lore	INT + 10	Track, forage
Shaping	INT + POW	Shapers only
Practical	**Base**	**Use**
Athletics	DEX + STR	Climb, swim
Craft (trade)	INT + 10	Make, repair
Deception	DEX + INT	Sneak, hide
Driving	DEX + INT	Carts, wagons
Healing	INT + 10	Treat wounds
Influence	CHA + 10	Persuade
Mechanisms	DEX + INT	Locks, traps
Perception	INT + POW	Notice
Performance	CHA + 10	Entertain
Riding	DEX + POW	Mounts
Sailing	DEX + INT	Boats, ships
Streetwise	CHA + POW	Rumours
Trade	INT + 10	Haggle, value

EXAMPLE

Mara, a human warrior, takes the quick array: STR 16, CON 14, DEX 13, SIZ 12, INT 11, POW 10, CHA 10. She has HP 13, MWL 7, PP 10, DM +1D4 and Combat Order 12, or 9 in leather. With 30 Combat points, her Close Combat is 59%.

IMPROVEMENT AND TALENTS

Improvement Points buy Talents now and better skills later.

5. IMPROVEMENT POINTS

Improvement Points (IP) buy Talents and improvements. You start with **10 IP**, minus your ancestry's abilities. The GM awards **3 to 5 IP** after each adventure, and three months of practice or study earns 1 IP. Unspent IP carry over.

Spend	Cost
A Talent, if you meet its requirement	Listed
One skill +5%, or +3% above 50%; each skill once between adventures, never above 100%	1 IP
+1 to a characteristic other than SIZ, up to its maximum; 18 at most when you start	5 IP

More IP at the start: keep back up to 20 points from each of your Resistance, Combat and Practical pools. Every 5 kept back gives 1 IP, at most 12. They buy Talents or characteristics, not skills.

Shaping costs 20 IP. Only a human can start with it: all 10 starting IP, plus 10 from 50 skill points kept back. Other ancestries learn it in play.

6. GEAR AND FINISH

Take leather armour, a ranged weapon, a dagger, and either a two-handed close weapon or a shield and a one-handed one. Add a backpack, 10 m of rope, two weeks' provisions, flint and tinder, a waterskin and **4D6 × 10 SP**. Record HP, MWL, PP, DM, Combat Order, gear, Talents and **2 Hero Points**.

ANCESTRY MAXIMA

Ancestry	STR	CON	DEX	SIZ	INT	POW	CHA
Human	21	21	21	21	21	21	21
Elf	18	21	24	18	24	21	21
Dwarf	24	24	18	18	21	21	21
Orc	24	24	21	24	18	18	18
Goblin	18	21	24	15	24	21	21
Lizardfolk	24	24	18	21	21	21	18

TALENTS

Talents are trained knacks. Each shows its IP cost and the requirement to buy it; Shaping is on the Shaping page. A Talent marked † replaces a hit's damage, and only if no Dodge or full Parry stops the hit; use one † Talent per attack. Any other full-rules Talent can be bought at its listed cost.

- **Ambusher** (4 IP; Deception 76%): your first attack in a scene, from hiding against an unaware target, turns an ordinary hit into a Critical.
- **Battle Awareness** (3 IP; Perception 51%): while you are aware of an enemy, attacks on you from the flank or behind gain no +1B.
- **Disarm** † (2 IP; Close Combat 51%): knock one held item 1D6 m away.
- **Expertise** (2 IP; 51% in that skill): in one narrow use of a skill, such as climbing, sneaking, persuading, commanding, tracking, or Natural Lore in one terrain, ignore one Penalty die. It never adds a Bonus die. Take it again for another use.
- **Favoured Weapon** (3 IP; Close or Ranged Combat 51%): +1 damage with one named weapon.
- **Field Surgeon** (3 IP; Healing 76%): perform Surgery anywhere outside combat; your success ends Wounded at once.
- **Iron Fist** (3 IP; Unarmed Combat 51%): your unarmed blows deal 1D4 and count as Medium.
- **Killing Angle** (4 IP; Deception 51%): once per round, +1D4 damage to a close or unarmed attack against a flanked, rear or unaware target; not on a Critical.
- **Missile Guard** (2 IP; Close Combat 51%): no -1P when you Active Guard with a shield.
- **Off-Hand Mastery** (5 IP; Close or Unarmed Combat 76%): no -1P on off-hand attacks and Parries.
- **Practised Hands** (4 IP; Healing 51%): your first aid restores 1D4 + 2 HP, and you can retry a failed attempt once.
- **Protector** (2 IP; Close Combat 51%): with a ready shield, spend your base Reaction to Parry a hit on an adjacent ally.
- **Quick Reflexes** (3 IP; DEX 13, Dodge 51%): +2 Combat Order.
- **Rally** (4 IP; Influence 51%): Combat Action: two allies who hear you gain +1B on their next test.
- **Rapid Shot** (4 IP; Ranged Combat 76%): Combat Action and all Reactions: shoot a bow or sling twice, each at -1P.
- **Shield Cover** (3 IP; Close Combat 51%): with a ready medium or large shield, ranged attacks and Shaping bolts aimed at you take -1P.
- **Shield Rush** † (3 IP; Close Combat 51%): with a shield, push the target 2 m; it tests Athletics at -1P or falls prone.
- **Silent Step** (3 IP; Deception 51%): while you move at half speed or less, anyone trying to notice you takes -1P.
- **Steady Casting** (3 IP; Shaping 76%): ignore one Penalty die from Wounded or a grapple on Shaping tests.
- **Trip** † (3 IP; Close or Unarmed Combat 51%): knock the target prone.

COMBAT

Attack first. If it hits, an aware defender can react.

THE ROUND

A round is five seconds. When a fight starts, everyone rolls **1D10 + Combat Order** once and acts from highest to lowest; ties go to the higher DEX. Each round you have:

- one **Combat Action:** attack, Aim, grapple, cast, Intimidate, or use a skill or item;
- one **Movement Action:** move up to your Movement, stand up, drop prone, or ready an item while moving half as far;
- one **Reaction:** Dodge, Parry or an Opportunity Attack, when something triggers it, even on another's turn.

Unused actions are lost. **Delay:** act later in the round, after someone you choose.

MOVING IN A FIGHT

Option	Cost and effect
Disengage	Movement Action: move away; adjacent enemies can make an Opportunity Attack.
Withdraw	Both actions: move away without Opportunity Attacks. Keep your Reactions.
Sprint	Both actions: move twice your Movement. Your only Reaction is a Dodge.
Charge	Both actions and all Reactions: run straight at least 5 m, up to twice your Movement, and attack. +1D6 damage on a hit.
Set Weapon	Combat Action: brace a Set weapon. The first foe to Charge you before your next turn takes your attack first, at +1B.

ATTACK

Roll **Close Combat** for held weapons and shields, **Unarmed Combat** for fists, kicks and natural weapons, or **Ranged Combat**. Unarmed blows deal 1D3. A result at or under your skill hits, unless the defender stops it.

TWO WEAPONS

With two ready one-handed items (an empty hand counts as a fist), once per round choose one:

- right after a normal close or unarmed attack, attack with the other at **-1P**, at no cost; or
- keep the other for one extra Parry or Opportunity Attack at **-1P**. It cannot Dodge.

DEFEND

When an attack hits you and you are aware of it, you can spend one Reaction. One Reaction answers one attack. Your roll opposes the attack roll; the attacker does not roll again.

- **Dodge:** if you win, the attack misses. -1P against ranged attacks. Once per round.
- **Parry:** Close Combat with a ready weapon or shield, or Unarmed Combat against an unarmed attack. If you win, block damage by Size.
- **Active Guard:** Parry a ranged attack. Against a thrown weapon, use a ready weapon at -1P or a shield normally; against arrows, bolts and stones, a shield only, at -1P.

PARRY SIZE

Weapons and shields are **Light, Medium, Heavy or Huge**. Fists, kicks, arrows, bolts and stones are Light.

Your parrying item is...	Damage blocked
The same Size or larger	All
One Size smaller	Half, rounded up
Two or more Sizes smaller	None

DAMAGE

Roll the weapon's damage. Add your **Damage Modifier (DM)** to close, unarmed and thrown attacks, but not to bows, crossbows or slings. Subtract a winning Parry, then the target's **Armour Points (AP)**. The rest comes off HP. Damage and HP never go below 0.

> **Example.** An ogre's Heavy club hits for 12. Your Medium sword Parries and blocks half: 6 remain. Leather armour (2 AP) stops 2. You lose 4 HP.

CRITICALS AND FUMBLES

- A **Critical hit** deals maximum weapon damage plus maximum positive DM, nothing more, and ignores armour.
- An ordinary successful Dodge or Parry turns a Critical hit into an ordinary one: roll damage and apply armour, but the defence blocks nothing.
- A **Critical defence** that wins stops any hit.
- A **Fumble** brings an immediate mishap: a dropped weapon, a fall, an opening.

MORE COMBAT

Second weapons, missiles, grapples, threats, and wounds.

OPPORTUNITY ATTACK

When an adjacent enemy moves away, or gives you a clear opening, spend your Reaction on one Close Combat attack.

SURPRISE

An unaware defender cannot React. Sneaking up is Deception against Perception. Being behind someone does not by itself make them unaware.

RANGED ATTACKS

- **Range:** up to the weapon's Range, attack normally; up to twice its Range, at -2P; farther, you cannot hit.
- **Aim:** Combat Action. Your next shot at that target gains +1B. You lose the Aim if you React, lose sight of the target, or do not shoot with your next Combat Action.
- **Reload:** nock an arrow with your Movement Action, moving up to half your Movement. A light crossbow takes your Movement Action and your Reaction; a heavy crossbow takes the whole round.
- **Into a melee:** apply cover. Only a Fumble hits someone else nearby.
- **At arm's length:** within 2 m, a bow, crossbow, sling or javelin is a club: 1D6 + DM at -1P. Daggers, hatchets and shortspears work as close weapons.

GRAPPLE

Combat Action, with a free hand, against an adjacent target: roll **Unarmed Combat**. An aware target can spend its Reaction to oppose with Dodge or Parry; otherwise you only need a success. If you win, you hold the target, and while the hold lasts, both of you:

- cannot take a Movement Action;
- take -1P on every test; and
- fight only unarmed or with a Light one-handed weapon.

Escape: Combat Action and an opposed Unarmed Combat test. The holder can let go at any time on their turn.

MOUNTED

Use the mount's Movement. Your attack skill cannot exceed your Riding. A mount untrained for battle might bolt: test Riding at the start of each round.

INTIMIDATE

Combat Action: demand surrender or retreat from one foe or a group. Oppose your **Influence** against the **Persistence** of the foe or its leader. The foe gets one modifier: at full strength **+2B**; outnumbering you but down 20% **+1B**; outnumbered and wounded **-1P**; lost half its HP or numbers **-2P**.

If you win, the GM decides how the foe gives way. The wounded might flee or surrender; healthy foes more often hesitate and lose a turn. A foe at full strength, or outnumbering you, surrenders only to a Critical against a failed roll. A fumbled Persistence breaks it at once.

MAJOR WOUNDS

One hit that deals **at least your MWL** after armour causes a Major Wound:

- **Wounded:** -1P on every test.
- **Bleeding:** lose 1 HP at the end of every round.

They do not stack, but a new Major Wound can restart Bleeding.

DYING

At **0 HP** you fall unconscious and are **Dying**. You die at the end of the **third round** unless someone stabilises you.

Stabilise: an adjacent helper spends the whole round, staying put, and passes **Healing**; -2P without a Healing Kit. It stops Bleeding and Dying but restores no HP.

HEALING

- **First aid:** after a fight, a patient who is not Wounded can receive one Healing attempt before their next full rest. Success restores **1D4 HP**.
- **Surgery:** a Wounded patient heals naturally only after Surgery: a Healing test in safety, outside combat. Success restores **1 HP**.
- **Rest:** with only light activity, recover **CON / 4 HP a day**. Wounded ends when HP rises above MWL.
- **Power Points:** recover a quarter of your PP per two hours of rest; eight hours restores them all. At 0 PP you fall unconscious.

HERO POINTS SAVE LIVES

Spend 1 to keep a Major Wound's HP loss without Wounded or Bleeding, and 1 more at 0 HP to become stable instead of Dying. One hit can need both.

EQUIPMENT

The same weapons, armour and prices as the full rules.

CLOSE WEAPONS

Weapon	Damage	Size	Hands	STR/DEX	ENC	Cost
Dagger	1D4+1	Light	1H, Thrown	—	—	20 SP
Club	1D6	Light	Flex	5/9	1	20 SP
Hatchet	1D6	Light	1H, Thrown	5/9	1	20 SP
Shortsword	1D6	Medium	1H	5/5	1	100 SP
Shortspear	1D6	Medium	Flex, Set, Thrown	5/5	2	20 SP
Arming sword, scimitar	1D8	Medium	1H	9/9	2	150 SP
Battleaxe, war hammer, ball and chain	1D8	Medium	1H	9/9	2	120 SP
Mace	1D8	Medium	Flex	9/9	2	120 SP
Longsword	1D8	Medium	Flex	13/11	2	250 SP
Quarterstaff	1D8	Medium	2H	5/9	2	20 SP
Longspear	1D8+1	Medium	2H, Set	9/5	2	30 SP
Polearm	1D8	Heavy	2H, Set	9/9	3	200 SP
Lance	1D10	Heavy	Flex, Set	11/9	3	150 SP
Great axe, great hammer, military flail	2D8	Heavy	2H	13/5	4	200 SP
Greatsword	2D8	Heavy	2H	13/9	4	300 SP
Shield, small	1D4	Medium	1H	—	1	50 SP
Shield, medium	1D6	Heavy	1H	9/—	2	150 SP
Shield, large	1D6	Huge	1H	13/—	3	300 SP

RANGED WEAPONS

Weapon	Damage	Range	STR/DEX	ENC	Cost
Dart	1D3	STR m	—/9	—	15 SP
Improvised rock	1D4	STR m	5/5	1	—
Javelin	1D6	STR × 2 m	5/9	1	20 SP
Whip	1D3	5 m	—/9	—	50 SP
Sling	1D6	50 m	—/9	—	5 SP
Shortbow	1D8	75 m	9/9	1	75 SP
Crossbow, light	1D8	125 m	5/9	1	150 SP
Longbow	1D10	150 m	13/9	1	150 SP
Crossbow, heavy	2D6	150 m	9/9	2	350 SP

WEAPON TAGS

1H / 2H: hands needed. **Flex:** in two hands, +2 damage and 2 less STR. **Set:** can be braced against a Charge. **Thrown:** adds DM and keeps its Size; a thrown dagger or hatchet reaches STR m, a shortspear STR × 2 m, and each needs DEX 9. Missiles add no DM and are Light. Below a STR or DEX minimum: -1P. Improvised weapons deal 1 less damage. 10 arrows cost 1 SP; 10 bolts, 2 SP.

ARMOUR

Armour	AP	ENC	Cost
Leather	2	3	500 SP
Ringmail	3	4	1,000 SP
Scalemail	4	6	1,500 SP
Chainmail	5	7	3,000 SP
Platemail	6	9	9,000 SP

Armour cannot stack; ENC lowers Combat Order.

ADVENTURING

Distance, weariness, falls, fire and poison push back.

TRAVEL

A day is ten hours of travel in fair weather.

Pace	Per day	Cost
Marching	30 km	Arrive ready to fight
Hiking	50 km	A Fatigue test at day's end
Riding slowly	30 km	With pack animals or wagons
Riding	50 km	
Riding fast	90 km	Rider and mount test Fatigue at day's end

On rough ground, multiply: light brush 80%; medium brush, light woods or hills 70%; heavy woodland 50%.

Navigation: test Natural Lore once per uncertain day. A failure loses a quarter of the day's progress; a Fumble means no progress, and you are lost.

MOVING ABOUT

Climb at a quarter of your Movement where there are holds; an Athletics success doubles it. **Swim** at half Movement in calm water; test Athletics in currents, bad weather or under a heavy load. **Jump:** with a 5 m run, a success clears about twice your height across, or half your height up.

FATIGUE

After hard effort, such as a long fight, a sprint, or a hard climb or swim, the GM can call for a **Fatigue test**: Resilience.

State	Tests	Movement	Combat Order
Fatigued	-1P	Three-quarters	-3
Exhausted	-2P	Half	-6

Fail once to become Fatigued. More hard effort calls for another test at -1P; fail it to become Exhausted. A fumbled test knocks you out for 3D6 minutes, and you wake Fatigued. **20 - CON hours** of rest, at least 1, clears either state.

LOAD

You carry up to **STR + SIZ** ENC freely. Above that you take -1P on physical and Fatigue tests and move at half speed. You can never carry twice that. Twenty small items in a container count as 1 ENC.

HAZARDS

Hazard	Effect
Falling	1D6 per full 3 m, ignoring armour; you land prone. If you can control the landing, an Athletics success removes 1D6, a Critical 2D6; a Fumble maximises the dice.
Fire	Each round: candle 1, torch 1D4, campfire 1D6, bonfire or burning room 2D6, lava 3D6. Metal armour does not help.
Holding breath	CON rounds; then Resilience each round at a cumulative -1P. On a failure take, each round until you reach air: water 2D6, thick smoke 1D6. Armour does not help.
Poison, disease	After the Delay, oppose your Resilience against its Potency. Lose and suffer its effect. A disease returns after each Delay until you win. Treatment first gives +1B.
Exposure, hunger, thirst	Safe for CON hours without shelter, CON days without food, CON × 2 hours without water (less in heat). After that, a daily Fatigue test at -1P and 1D6 damage for each lack.

OBJECTS

Attacks on still objects hit automatically. Subtract AP, then HP; at 0 HP the object breaks.

Object	AP	HP
Wooden chair	2	6
Wooden door	2	25
Iron door	4	75
Castle gate	4	120

USEFUL GEAR

Item	Cost
Healing Kit: five Healing attempts	25 SP
Climbing Kit: +1B to climb	25 SP
Crowbar: +1B to force	25 SP
Lock Picks: +1B to open locks	75 SP
Lantern: 3 m of light, 2 hours a flask	10 SP
Torch: 3 m of light for an hour	4 CP

Money: 10 copper pieces (CP) make 1 silver piece (SP); 10 SP make 1 gold piece (GP).

SHAPING

Magic is built from what you affect and what you do to it.

BECOMING A SHAPER

Shaping (20 IP; a supernatural initiation or discovery) is a Talent. Only a human can afford it at the start; others learn it in play. It gives:

- the **Shaping** skill, base INT + POW; you can add up to 30 Knowledge points;
- a **specialty**, one Form or one Technique, and two known **cells** that contain it; and
- **Sense Magic** and **Dispel**, which need no cell.

More cells: 2 IP with your specialty; otherwise 4 IP, after an ordeal or with a master.

Your **Practice** is what you visibly do to cast: speech, gesture, a focus or prayer. If it is prevented, you cannot cast. Your **Tell** is a sign around you and your target, seen within 10 × M metres (at least 3 m). It shows magic, not its purpose.

CELLS

A cell joins a **Technique** (what you do) and a **Form** (what you affect), such as Unmake·Fire. You can cast only cells you know.

Technique	What it does
Conjure	Create things, barriers, beings
Bend	Move or control; no damage
Unmake	Damage, destroy, suppress, banish
Alter	Heal, transform, impose conditions
Ward	Protect, resist or deny
Scry	Learn, sense or speak; no change

Form	What it affects
Fire	Flame, heat and light
Water/Ice	Water, cold and ice
Air/Storm	Air, wind, sound, weather and lightning
Earth/Stone	Soil, stone and natural minerals
Flesh	Bodies, living or dead; plants
Mind	Thought, emotion, memory, senses
Force/Motion	Force, movement, weight and mass
Spirit	Souls, spirits and possession
Paths	Routes, thresholds and distance
Fate	Chance, omens and vows

RULES OF THUMB

Damage, healing and lost actions happen once; Duration never repeats them. Same-kind magic does not stack. Magic grants no extra actions or resources. Conjured things vanish when the Duration ends. Only Dispel ends active magic.

BUILD AN EFFECT

Say: **using [cell], I cause [outcome] at [Range], affecting [Reach], for [Duration].** The GM confirms it before you roll.

Magnitude (M) = Intensity of each outcome + Range + Duration + Reach, +1 for Direct Harm.

Intensity (I) is an outcome's strength: see Common outcomes. Each different outcome adds its own Intensity; Range, Duration and Reach count once.

Rating	Range	Duration	Reach
0	Self, touch	Instant	One target
1	15 m	A scene, 10 min	2 targets, 3 m radius
2	50 m	To a full rest	5 targets, 10 m radius
3	Visible point	Ritual	Ritual

Instant lasts at most to the target's next turn; a full rest, at most 8 hours. Reach also limits size: 0 a person or door, 1 a wagon, 2 a room. Range 1–3 needs a clear route: seeing through a barrier is not enough. An area includes allies.

YOUR LIMITS

Shaping	Maximum I	Safe M
0–25%	1	1
26–50%	2	2
51–75%	3	3
76–99%	4	4
100%	5	5

No outcome can exceed your maximum Intensity. You can cast up to **Safe M + 2**, at -1P for Safe + 1 and -2P for Safe + 2. This is **overreach**: failing it brings Backlash. Intensity 5 or anything bigger needs a **ritual** (full rules).

TWO EXAMPLES

Firebolt: Unmake·Fire, 2D6 Projected Harm (I2) at 15 m (Range 1) = **M3**.

Stone skin for two: Ward·Earth/Stone, 4 AP against blows (I2), 15 m (Range 1), a scene (Duration 1), two allies (Reach 1) = **M5**.

CAST AND SUSTAIN

Pay Power Points, beat the defence, keep the magic going.

COMMON OUTCOMES

Use the lowest Intensity that covers what you want. Your cell must allow it.

Outcome	Intensity buys
Harm	I D6 damage, no DM. Choose Projected or Direct Harm.
Heal	I D4 HP; stops Bleeding and Dying. I3+ counts as Surgery. Once per subject per rest.
Protect	2 × I AP against physical or elemental harm; both: +1 I. Use it or armour, whichever is higher.
Barrier	2 × I AP and 5 × I HP; it blocks movement and attacks.
Boost, hinder	One skill: I2 +1B or -1P; I4 +2B or -2P.
Restrain	I1 prone, or half Movement for a turn; I2 hold a person or push 3 m; I3 lose a Combat Action; I4 incapacitate.
Sway a mind	I1 colour an emotion; I2 a reasonable command; I3 one against their interest; I4 full control.
Move	I2 climb, swim or walk a surface; I3 fly; I4 pass through a substance. Speed: I1 +3 m; I2 ×1.5; I3 ×2.
Senses	I1 Low-Light Sight; I2 Night Vision; I3 Blind Sight through one sense. Hide: I2 -1P to notice; I3 undetectable.
Learn	I1 a clue; I2 locate, diagnose or talk; I3 watch afar or read surface thoughts; I4 deep secrets.
Summon	A being for the Duration. I1: 3 HP, 25%, 1D3. I2: 6 HP, 1 AP, 40%, 1D6. I3: 10 HP, 2 AP, 55%, 1D8. I4: 14 HP, 3 AP, 70%, 2D6.

HARM: PROJECTED OR DIRECT

Projected Harm crosses space like an arrow: Dodge or shield Active Guard, both at -1P; cover and armour apply. **Direct Harm** (+1 M) arises inside chosen targets: they resist with Resilience, or Persistence for mind and soul, and a win cancels it. Only magical protection helps against it.

SENSE MAGIC AND DISPEL

Sense Magic: Combat Action and 1 PP; a Shaping test finds active magic within 15 m and its Form. **Dispel:** Combat Action; M is the target's M plus Range. Cast normally, then also beat a fresh Shaping roll for the original caster.

CAST

Spend your **Combat Action**, perform your Practice and roll **Shaping**. You must have PP to cover the full M. A calm, cosmetic trick (M0) is free and automatic.

Result	You pay
Critical	Half M
Success	M
Failure within Safe M	1 PP; no effect
Failure while overreaching	Half M; no effect; Backlash
Fumble	M; Backlash

Backlash (roll 1D4, or the GM chooses): **1** take M damage, ignoring armour; **2** lose M more PP; **3** a weaker version of the effect strikes you or something near; **4** become Fatigued, or one step worse.

DEFENDING AGAINST MAGIC

Each target opposes the casting roll; the Shaper must succeed and win.

Effect	Defence
A bolt at one target	Dodge -1P, or shield Active Guard -1P
An area you can avoid	Dodge -1P
A change to body or matter	Resilience; no Reaction
A change to mind or soul	Persistence; no Reaction
Willing, yourself, an object	None

A winning shield Active Guard blocks by Size. A spell's Size follows its Intensity: I1 Light, I2 Medium, I3 Heavy, I4 Huge. A Critical casting is not maximised and does not ignore armour.

KEEP IT GOING

- All your ongoing effects together cannot exceed your **INT** in M. Dismiss one on your turn, freely.
- A lasting benefit needs no action. **Concentration**, or directing another's body, costs your Combat Action each round; damage or distraction calls for Persistence, or it ends.
- A **summon** follows one standing order, such as "guard me". Changing it costs your Movement Action within 15 m. Keep one fighting summon, or one controlled subject, at a time.
- Held or controlled by magic? Spend a Combat Action to repeat your defence against the stored casting roll.

GAMEMASTER

Roll when it matters, keep it moving, and let the world bite back.

WHEN TO ROLL

Roll when the outcome is uncertain and failure has a real consequence. Warn the players before a risky roll. If success would give only something minor, give it without a roll. Ask for one test for a long task, not one per step.

SETTING DIFFICULTY

There are no difficulty numbers. Most tests use the plain skill; let the situation add dice. A clear advantage is +1B, a hard task -1P, and a very hard one -2P. If it cannot fail, it succeeds; if it cannot succeed, do not roll.

MORALE

Foes want to live. When a fight turns against them, the wounded might flee or surrender, while healthy foes rarely just run. Use Intimidate when the heroes demand it.

REWARDS

Award **3 IP** for modest progress, **4** for a completed adventure and **5** for a major achievement, plus a Hero Point for heroic play.

QUICK NPCS

Write a description, a level and gear: **Guard 50 (Shortsword 1D6+1, Leather 2).** The guard has 50% in what guards do best, Close Combat and Perception; 40% in related skills such as Dodge, Resilience and Ranged Combat; 30% or less in the rest. A minor NPC has **10 HP and Combat Order 10** unless the role calls for more.

Level	Typical NPC
30	Frightened villager, untrained thug
40	Bandit, militia
50	Guard, hunter, sellsword
60	Sergeant, assassin, cult leader
70	Champion, master of a craft

CREATURES

Any full-rules creature works as written. Undead and constructs never bleed, breathe, tire or suffer poison; at 0 HP they are destroyed. **Threat:** roughly as many foes as player characters makes a fair fight. Raise one foe's skill or gear rather than adding more bodies; crowds of weak foes mostly cost time.

COMMON CREATURES

Wolf · HP 12 · MWL 6 · AP 0 · Move 23 m · CO 9 · Dodge 39%, Persistence 33%, Resilience 42%. Bite 50%, 1D8, Medium; Claw 50%, 1D6, Medium.

Bear · HP 19 · MWL 10 · AP 3 (hide) · Move 23 m · CO 8 · Dodge 33%, Persistence 33%, Resilience 39%. Bite 60%, 1D8+2D6, Heavy; Claw 60%, 1D6+2D6, Heavy.

Giant Spider · HP 22 · MWL 11 · AP 4 (chitin) · Move 15 m ground, 23 m on web · CO 12 · Dodge 48%, Persistence 33%, Resilience 51%. Bite 50%, 1D6+1D6, Heavy; Web 50%, special, Heavy, 15 m. Web: Combat Action, Unarmed Combat against Athletics within 15 m; a caught target cannot move and takes -1P. Venom: Potency 51, -6 DEX.

Goblin · HP 9 · MWL 5 · AP 2 (leather) · Move 15 m · CO 11 · Dodge 50%, Persistence 20%, Resilience 35%. Shortspear 40%, 1D6, Medium; Small Shield 40%, 1D4, Medium; Sling 50%, 1D6, 50 m. Blind Sight (heat). Deception 75%.

Orc · HP 13 · MWL 7 · AP 2 (leather) · Move 15 m · CO 8 · Dodge 35%, Persistence 35%, Resilience 35%. Scimitar 40%, 1D8+1D4, Medium; Medium Shield 40%, 1D6+1D4, Heavy; Shortbow 50%, 1D8, 75 m. Adrenaline Surge, as the Orc ancestry.

Skeleton · HP 8 · MWL 4 · AP 2 (leather) · Move 15 m · CO 3 · Dodge 10%, Persistence 100%, Resilience 100%. Arming Sword 35%, 1D8, Medium; Medium Shield 35%, 1D6, Heavy. Mindless undead. Halve piercing damage after armour.

Zombie · HP 7 · MWL 4 · AP 0 · Move 7 m · CO 4 · Dodge 0%, Persistence 100%, Resilience 100%. Fist 50%, 1D3+1D6, Light. Mindless undead.

Ghoul · HP 12 · MWL 6 · AP 0 · Move 15 m · CO 11 · Dodge 40%, Persistence 30%, Resilience 40%. Claw 60%, 1D4+1D4, Medium; Bite 60%, 1D6+1D4, Medium. Howl: listeners within 11 m oppose its Persistence or take -1P to attacks and Reactions. Venom: Potency 22, paralysis.

Ogre · HP 18 · MWL 9 · AP 2 (skin) · Move 15 m · CO 11 · Dodge 35%, Persistence 45%, Resilience 35%. Great Axe 60%, 2D8+2D6, Heavy; Improvised Rock 40%, 1D4+2D6, Light, 23 m; Fist 60%, 1D6+2D6, Light.

Troll · HP 23 · MWL 12 · AP 3 (hide) · Move 23 m · CO 7 · Dodge 25%, Persistence 25%, Resilience 60%. Club 40%, 1D6+2D6, Light; Claw 40%, 1D6+2D6, Heavy. Regenerates 1D6 HP at the start of each turn, even at 0 HP, unless burned since its last turn. Blind Sight (heat).

OPEN GAME LICENSE

Version 1.0a, with the copyright notices it requires.

The rules text on this site is Open Game Content, published under the Open Game License 1.0a and derived from the works credited in Section 15 below. Section 10 of that licence requires a copy to travel with every distribution of the content, which is what this page is.

TERMS OF THE LICENSE

The following text is the property of Wizards of the Coast Inc. and is Copyright 2000 Wizards of the Coast, Inc ("Wizards"). All Rights Reserved.

1. Definitions: (a)"Contributors" means the copyright and/or trademark owners who have contributed Open Game Content; (b)"Derivative Material" means copyrighted material including derivative works and translations (including into other computer languages), potation, modification, correction, addition, extension, upgrade, improvement, compilation, abridgment or other form in which an existing work may be recast, transformed or adapted; (c) "Distribute" means to reproduce, license, rent, lease, sell, broadcast, publicly display, transmit or otherwise distribute; (d)"Open Game Content" means the game mechanic and includes the methods, procedures, processes and routines to the extent such content does not embody the Product Identity and is an enhancement over the prior art and any additional content clearly identified as Open Game Content by the Contributor, and means any work covered by this License, including translations and derivative works under copyright law, but specifically excludes Product Identity. (e) "Product Identity" means product and product line names, logos and identifying marks including trade dress; artifacts; creatures characters; stories, storylines, plots, thematic elements, dialogue, incidents, language, artwork, symbols, designs, depictions, likenesses, formats, poses, concepts, themes and graphic, photographic and other visual or audio representations; names and descriptions of characters, spells, enchantments, personalities, teams, personas, likenesses and special abilities; places, locations, environments, creatures, equipment, magical or supernatural abilities or effects, logos, symbols, or graphic designs; and any other trademark or registered trademark clearly identified as Product identity by the owner of the Product Identity, and which specifically excludes the Open Game Content; (f) "Trademark" means the logos, names, mark, sign, motto, designs that are used by a Contributor to identify itself or its products or the associated products contributed to the Open Game License by the Contributor (g) "Use", "Used" or "Using" means to use, Distribute, copy, edit, format, modify, translate and otherwise create Derivative Material of Open Game Content. (h) "You" or "Your" means the licensee in terms of this agreement.
2. The License: This License applies to any Open Game Content that contains a notice indicating that the Open Game Content may only be Used under and in terms of this License. You must affix such a notice to any Open Game Content that you Use. No terms may be added to or subtracted from this License except as described by the License itself. No other terms or conditions may be applied to any Open Game Content distributed using this License.
3. Offer and Acceptance: By Using the Open Game Content You indicate Your acceptance of the terms of this License.
4. Grant and Consideration: In consideration for agreeing to use this License, the Contributors grant You a perpetual, worldwide, royalty-free, non-exclusive license with the exact terms of this License to Use, the Open Game Content.
5. Representation of Authority to Contribute: If You are contributing original material as Open Game Content, You represent that Your Contributions are Your original creation and/or You have sufficient rights to grant the rights conveyed by this License.
6. Notice of License Copyright: You must update the COPYRIGHT NOTICE portion of this License to include the exact text of the COPYRIGHT NOTICE of any Open Game Content You are copying, modifying or distributing, and You must add the title, the copyright date, and the copyright holder's name to the COPYRIGHT NOTICE of any original Open Game Content you Distribute.
7. Use of Product Identity: You agree not to Use any Product Identity, including as an indication as to compatibility, except as expressly licensed in another, independent Agreement with the owner of each element of that Product Identity. You agree not to indicate compatibility or co-adaptability with any Trademark or Registered Trademark in conjunction with a work containing Open Game Content except as expressly licensed in another, independent Agreement with the owner of such Trademark or Registered Trademark. The use of any Product Identity in Open Game Content does not constitute a challenge to the ownership of that Product Identity. The owner of any Product Identity used in Open Game Content shall retain all rights, title and interest in and to that Product Identity.
8. Identification: If you distribute Open Game Content You must clearly indicate which portions of the work that you are distributing are Open Game Content.
9. Updating the License: Wizards or its designated Agents may publish updated versions of this License. You may use any authorized version of this License to copy, modify and distribute any Open Game Content originally distributed under any version of this License.
10. Copy of this License: You MUST include a copy of this License with every copy of the Open Game Content You Distribute.
11. Use of Contributor Credits: You may not market or advertise the Open Game Content using the name of any Contributor unless You have written permission from the Contributor to do so.
12. Inability to Comply: If it is impossible for You to comply with any of the terms of this License with respect to some or all of the Open Game Content due to statute, judicial order, or governmental regulation then You may not Use any Open Game Material so affected.
13. Termination: This License will terminate automatically if You fail to comply with all terms herein and fail to cure such breach within 30 days of becoming aware of the breach. All sublicenses shall survive the termination of this License.
14. Reformation: If any provision of this License is held to be unenforceable, such provision shall be reformed only to the extent necessary to make it enforceable.

15. COPYRIGHT NOTICE

Open Game License v 1.0a Copyright 2000, Wizards of the Coast, Inc.

Modern System Reference Document Copyright 2002, Wizards of the Coast, Inc.; Authors Bill Slavicsek, Jeff Grubb, Rich Redman, Charles Ryan, based on material by Jonathan Tweet, Monte Cook, Skip Williams, Richard Baker, Peter Adkison, Bruce R. Cordell, John Tynes, Andy Collins and JD Wiker.

System Reference Document Copyright 2000-2003, Wizards of the Coast, Inc.; Authors Jonathan Tweet, Monte Cook, Skip Williams, Rich Baker, Andy Collins, David Noonan, Rich Redman, Bruce R. Cordell, based on original material by E. Gary Gygax and Dave Arneson.

RuneQuest System Reference Document Copyright 2006, Mongoose Publishing; Author Matthew Sprange, based on original material by Greg Stafford.

RuneQuest Companion System Reference Document Copyright 2006, Mongoose Publishing; Author Greg Lynch et al., based on original material by Greg Stafford.

RuneQuest Monster System Reference Document Copyright 2006, Mongoose Publishing; Author Greg Lynch et al., based on original material by Greg Stafford.

OpenQuest Copyright 2009-2013, D101 Games; Author Newt Newport, Simon Bray, Paul Mitchner, Tom Zunder.

Legend Copyright 2011, Mongoose Publishing; Author Lawrence Whitaker Pete Nash et al., based on original material by Greg Stafford.

The Age of Shadow Copyright 2011; Author Kristian Richards

The Age of Shadow Campaign Guide Copyright 2011; Author Kristian Richards

Fantasy Crux Copyright 2024; Author Konstantinos Karasavvas

Fantasy Crux 2.0 Copyright 2026; Author Konstantinos Karasavvas